

LIVESTOCK FARMING

TOPIC 1: Introduction to Livestock Farming

Livestock farming is the rearing of animals for food, income and other products. Types include cattle, goats, sheep, pigs, poultry and rabbits. Benefits: meat, milk, eggs, leather, manure, employment and income.

TOPIC 2: Types of Poultry Birds

Poultry means domesticated birds kept for meat, eggs or both. Common types: chicken, turkey, duck, guinea fowl, pigeon and quail. Uses: food (meat and eggs), income, feathers and manure.

TOPIC 3: Breeds of Poultry Birds

Local breeds are hardy and adapted to the environment. Exotic breeds include layers (for eggs), broilers (for meat) and cockerels. Characteristics differ in size, growth rate, egg production and feed efficiency.

TOPIC 4: Poultry Housing

A good poultry house protects birds from weather, predators and disease. Types: deep litter, battery cage, fold unit. Requirements: good ventilation, adequate space, dry floor, easy cleaning, protection from rain and sun. Materials: wood, blocks, wire mesh, roofing sheets.

TOPIC 5: Poultry Equipment

Feeders (for feed), drinkers (for water), brooders (for heat for chicks), laying nests, perches. Keep equipment clean and in good condition to prevent disease.

TOPIC 6: Poultry Management Practices

Daily care of chicks, growers and layers includes feeding, watering, cleaning, observing health and record-keeping. Good sanitation reduces disease. Records help track performance and costs.

TOPIC 7: Poultry Diseases and Control

Common diseases: Newcastle disease, Coccidiosis, Fowl pox. Prevention: vaccination, good hygiene, proper nutrition, isolation of sick birds. Control: follow veterinary advice, dispose of dead birds safely.

TOPIC 8: Classification of Feed Ingredients

Feed provides energy, protein, vitamins and minerals. Ingredients: maize, sorghum (energy); groundnut cake, fish meal (protein); bone meal, salt (minerals); vitamin premixes. Balanced feed supports growth and production.

Summary

Livestock farming, especially poultry, provides food and income. Success depends on good housing, equipment, feeding, disease control and daily management.

End of Livestock Farming First Term Notes